

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

The Game of Life

A Journal Inspired by Florence Scovel Shinn



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · words, faith & intention

WELCOME

Before You Begin



In 1925, Florence Scovel Shinn wrote that life is not a battle — it's a game. And like any game, it goes better when you know the rules.

Her rules were simple and startling: your words set the direction, your expectations do the steering, and what you give out circles back.

'Your word is your wand,' she taught — meaning the things you say about your life are quietly building it.

This journal turns her ideas into practice: noticing what you speak, expect, give, and fear — and choosing better moves. Consider it your playbook.

[illegible]

This is a worksheet titled "The State of the Game". At the top center, there is a section labeled "STARTING POINT" in all caps. Below this label is a small red heart icon. Underneath the heart is a italicized prompt: "How has life felt lately — like a game you're playing, or a battle you're losing? Describe the board as you see it today." The main body of the page consists of 20 horizontal lines for writing. At the bottom center, the website address "ilikeitdeep.us" is printed.

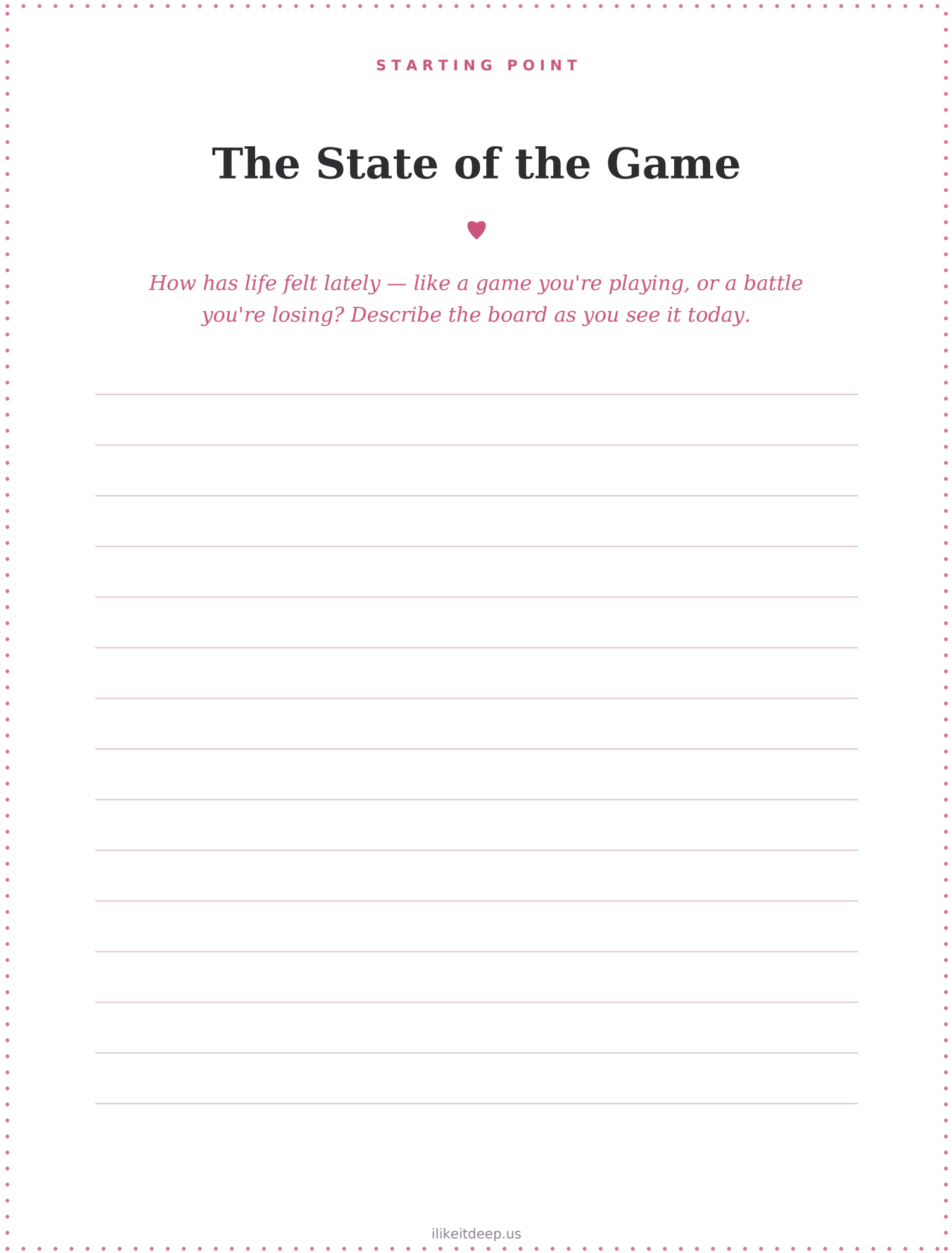
STARTING POINT

The State of the Game

A small red heart icon centered below the title.

*How has life felt lately — like a game you're playing, or a battle
you're losing? Describe the board as you see it today.*

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This is a worksheet template with a light gray background and a decorative border of small pink dots. At the top center, the words "STARTING POINT" are written in a bold, pink, sans-serif font. Below this, the title "The State of the Game" is prominently displayed in a large, bold, black serif font. Underneath the title is a small, solid pink heart icon. A paragraph of italicized pink text follows, asking the user to reflect on their current state of life or a game they are playing. The lower half of the page contains fifteen horizontal pink lines for writing. At the very bottom center, the website address "ilikeitdeep.us" is printed in a small, plain black font.

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PART ONE

Your Word Is Your Wand



*Shinn taught that we're always casting — the
only question is what.*

*What do you say about your life on autopilot — 'I'm always broke,' 'nothing works out,' 'I'm so tired'?
Write your reruns.*



*Where did those scripts come from? Whose voice
said them first?*



What would you never say about your best friend's life that you say about yours daily?



*Pick your worst rerun and flip it. Write the new line
— believable, but pointed forward.*



What do you WANT to be true? Write it in present-tense words, like Shinn would: boldly.



*For one day, catch yourself mid-negative-sentence.
What did you catch? What did you say instead?*



PART TWO

Expectation Sets the Table



*'Prepare for the thing you have asked for,'
Shinn said — act like it's coming.*

What are you hoping for but secretly expecting to fail? Be honest about the gap.



Where in your life are you 'preparing for the worst' so thoroughly that there's no room set for the best?



What would you do differently this week if you fully expected the good thing to arrive?



What's one small, concrete way to 'set the table' for what you want — the empty frame, the cleared closet, the saved seat?



What fear keeps ordering for you? Write it down, then write what courage would order instead.



Recall a time something worked out better than you dared expect. What does that memory make possible?



PART THREE

The Boomerang Rule



What you send out circles back. Play generously.

What are you putting out into the world lately — in energy, words, and deeds? The honest inventory.



Where are you gripping something so tightly — money, a person, an outcome — that nothing new can land in your hand?



What could you give freely this week — help, praise, forgiveness, a real compliment — and to whom?



What resentment is costing you rent? What would releasing it (for YOUR sake) look like?



Where has generosity already come back to you in your life? Trace one boomerang.



Write your new rules of play — five personal rules for how you'll play the game from now on.



The Player's Daily Moves



Small moves that change the whole board. Check the ones you'll play this week.

- ☐ Catch one negative rerun and flip the sentence out loud
- ☐ Speak one bold present-tense intention before coffee
- ☐ Set the table: do one thing that assumes the good outcome
- ☐ Give one sincere compliment with no agenda
- ☐ Release one grip — a worry, a grudge, a need to control the how
- ☐ Write down one thing that went right today, however small
- ☐ Say 'thank you' for something that hasn't arrived yet
- ☐ Replace one complaint with one request
- ☐ Do one generous thing quietly, telling no one
- ☐ End the day naming the move you're proudest of

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Wins on the Board



Every time a flipped word, a bold expectation, or a generous move pays off — log it here. Watch the game start playing FOR you.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Whether you take Shinn's ideas as spiritual law or simply
as brilliant psychology, the practice is the same:
watch your words, expect good boldly, give generously,
and loosen your grip on the how.

You've been playing this game your whole life.
Now you're playing it on purpose —
and players who play on purpose win differently.



*Life is a game. You just learned the
rules. Play boldly.*



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